

CIVIL SERVICES AND MISSION KARMAYOGI

THREE DESIGNED TRAITS, ONE → NEUTRALITY: WHAT IT IS → CONSTITUTIONAL SETTING CARD → THREE LAYERS OF CIVIL-SERVICE → SIX PILLARS OF THE → INSTITUTIONAL CHAIN IN FOUR

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g2 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00

THREE DESIGNED TRAITS, ONE PACKAGE

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IMPARTIAL SERVICE TO ANY ELECTED GOVERNMENT; NOT THE ABSENCE

CONTINUITY AND INSTITUTIONAL MEMORY ACROSS CHANGES OF POLITICAL GOVERNMENT

CONFIDENTIAL ADVICE; THE MINISTER ANSWERS PUBLICLY FOR THE POLICY

THE THREE WERE DESIGNED TOGETHER; WEAKENING ONE DESTABILISES THE

MUST REMEMBER

CIVIL SERVICES PROVIDE CONTINUITY, EXPERTISE, COORDINATION, IMPLEMENTATION

CORE CLAIM

- NEUTRALITY → impartial service to any elected government; not the absence of policy influence
- PERMANENCE → continuity and institutional memory across changes of political government

MECHANISM

- ANONYMITY → confidential advice; the minister answers publicly for the policy outcome
- RULE → the three were designed together; weakening one destabilises the other two

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- MUST REMEMBER: Civil services provide continuity, expertise, coordination, implementation...
- NEUTRALITY → impartial service to any elected government; not the absence of policy influence

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → the three were designed together; weakening one destabilises the other two.

01

STAGE 01

NEUTRALITY: WHAT IT IS AND WHAT IT IS NOT

WHAT IT IS AND WHAT IT IS NOT

IMPARTIAL IMPLEMENTATION OF LAWFUL POLICY IRRESPECTIVE OF PERSONAL PREFERENCE

THE REASON THE SAME OFFICER CAN SERVE SUCCESSIVE, IDEOLOGICALLY

IS NOT

SILENCE, PASSIVITY OR THE ABSENCE OF TECHNICAL AND EXPERT

LOYALTY TO THE GOVERNMENT OF THE DAY RATHER THAN

CORE CLAIM

- IS → impartial implementation of lawful policy irrespective of personal preference
- IS → the reason the same officer can serve successive, ideologically different governments

MECHANISM

- IS NOT → silence, passivity or the absence of technical and expert policy advice
- IS NOT → loyalty to the government of the day rather than to the Constitution

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- IS → impartial implementation of lawful policy irrespective of personal preference
- IS → the reason the same officer can serve successive, ideologically different governments

CORE CLAIM

- IS → impartial implementation of lawful policy irrespective of personal preference
- IS → the reason the same officer can serve successive, ideologically different governments

MECHANISM

- IS NOT → silence, passivity or the absence of technical and expert policy advice
- IS NOT → loyalty to the government of the day rather than to the Constitution

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- IS → impartial implementation of lawful policy irrespective of personal preference
- IS → the reason the same officer can serve successive, ideologically different governments

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: IS NOT → loyalty to the government of the day rather than to the Constitution.

02

STAGE 02

CONSTITUTIONAL SETTING CARD

CONSTITUTIONAL SETTING CARD

ARTICLES 309 TO 311

RECRUITMENT, SERVICE CONDITIONS, PLEASURE DOCTRINE, DISMISSAL SAFEGUARDS

ARTICLE 312

PARLIAMENT MAY CREATE AN ALL INDIA SERVICE AFTER THE

GOVERNANCE USE

TENURE PROTECTION IS THE LEGAL BASIS ON WHICH NEUTRALITY

COMMISSION COMPOSITION, APPOINTMENT AND REMOVAL DETAIL IS POLITY-OWNED

CORE CLAIM

- ARTICLES 309 TO 311 → recruitment, service conditions, pleasure doctrine, dismissal safeguards
- ARTICLE 312 → Parliament may create an All India Service after the Rajya Sabha resolution

MECHANISM

- GOVERNANCE USE → tenure protection is the legal basis on which neutrality rests
- BOUNDARY → commission composition, appointment and removal detail is Polity-owned

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- ARTICLES 309 TO 311 → recruitment, service conditions, pleasure doctrine, dismissal safeguards
- ARTICLE 312 → Parliament may create an All India Service after the Rajya Sabha resolution

CORE CLAIM

- ARTICLES 309 TO 311 → recruitment, service conditions, pleasure doctrine, dismissal safeguards
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CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- ARTICLES 309 TO 311 → recruitment, service conditions, pleasure doctrine, dismissal safeguards
- ARTICLE 312 → Parliament may create an All India Service after the Rajya Sabha resolution

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: BOUNDARY → commission composition, appointment and removal detail is Polity-owned.

03

STAGE 03

THREE LAYERS OF CIVIL-SERVICE LEGITIMACY

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NEUTRALITY, PERMANENCE AND ANONYMITY BUILT INTO THE DESIGN

CONDUCT RULES, VIGILANCE MACHINERY, DISCIPLINARY PROCESS, APPRAISAL

SUSTAINED PUBLIC BELIEF THAT UNELECTED DISCRETION IS EXERCISED IMPARTIALLY

THE FIRST TWO CAN BE FORMALLY SOUND WHILE THE

STRUCTURAL → neutrality, permanence and anonymity built into the design

PROCEDURAL → conduct rules, vigilance machinery, disciplinary process, appraisal

PERCEPTUAL → sustained public belief that unelected discretion is exercised impartially

CLAIM → the first two can be formally sound while the third erodes independently

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: BOUNDARY → commission composition, appointment and removal detail is Polity-owned.

03

STAGE 03 THREE LAYERS OF CIVIL-SERVICE LEGITIMACY

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04

STAGE 04 SIX PILLARS OF THE CAPACITY PROGRAMME

SIX PILLARS OF THE CAPACITY PROGRAMME

1 POLICY FRAMEWORK

THE REFORM INTENT AND ITS STATED SHIFT TO ROLE-BASED

2 INSTITUTIONAL FRAMEWORK

INCLUDING THE CAPACITY BUILDING COMMISSION

3 COMPETENCY FRAMEWORK

BEHAVIOURAL, FUNCTIONAL AND DOMAIN COMPETENCIES MAPPED TO ROLES

4 DIGITAL LEARNING FRAMEWORK

CORE CLAIM

- 1 POLICY FRAMEWORK → the reform intent and its stated shift to role-based learning
- 2 INSTITUTIONAL FRAMEWORK → including the Capacity Building Commission

MECHANISM

- 3 COMPETENCY FRAMEWORK → behavioural, functional and domain competencies mapped to roles
- 4 DIGITAL LEARNING FRAMEWORK → the online platform that delivers modules at scale

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- 5 ELECTRONIC HUMAN-RESOURCE MANAGEMENT → the personnel data spine of the reform
- 6 MONITORING AND EVALUATION → the pillar on which the verdict must ultimately rest

CORE CLAIM

- 1 POLICY FRAMEWORK → the reform intent and its stated shift to role-based learning
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MECHANISM

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- 6 MONITORING AND EVALUATION → the pillar on which the verdict must ultimately rest

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 6 MONITORING AND EVALUATION → the pillar on which the verdict must ultimately rest.

05

STAGE 05 INSTITUTIONAL CHAIN IN FOUR TIERS

INSTITUTIONAL CHAIN IN FOUR TIERS

APEX GUIDANCE

PRIME MINISTER'S HUMAN RESOURCES COUNCIL

CABINET SECRETARIAT COORDINATION UNIT

STANDARDS AND PLANS

CAPACITY BUILDING COMMISSION, ANNUAL CAPACITY BUILDING PLANS

PLATFORM OPERATION

KARMAYOGI BHARAT, THE GOVERNMENT-OWNED SPECIAL PURPOSE VEHICLE

APEX GUIDANCE → Prime Minister's Human Resources Council

COORDINATION → Cabinet Secretariat Coordination Unit

STANDARDS AND PLANS → Capacity Building Commission, Annual Capacity Building Plans

PLATFORM OPERATION → Karmayogi Bharat, the government-owned special purpose vehicle

TRAP → the Commission sets standards; it does not operate the platform

CORE CLAIM

- APEX GUIDANCE → Prime Minister's Human Resources Council
- COORDINATION → Cabinet Secretariat Coordination Unit

MECHANISM

- STANDARDS AND PLANS → Capacity Building Commission, Annual Capacity Building Plans
- PLATFORM OPERATION → Karmayogi Bharat, the government-owned special purpose vehicle

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- TRAP → the Commission sets standards; it does not operate the platform
- APEX GUIDANCE → Prime Minister's Human Resources Council

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP → the Commission sets standards; it does not operate the platform.

06

STAGE 06 DATED CAPACITY ANCHORS

DATED CAPACITY ANCHORS

CABINET APPROVAL

2 SEPTEMBER 2020, MINISTRY OF PERSONNEL, PUBLIC GRIEVANCES AND

COMMISSION ESTABLISHED

1 APRIL 2021, STATED ON THE COMMISSION'S OFFICIAL WEBSITE

OFFICIAL PAGE READ

2 SEPTEMBER 2026; REPOSITORY STATUS RE-VERIFIED 13 AUGUST 2026

ANNUAL CAPACITY BUILDING PLANS AND THE KARMAYOGI COMPETENCY MODEL

CABINET APPROVAL → 2 September 2020, Ministry of Personnel, Public Grievances and Pensions

COMMISSION ESTABLISHED → 1 April 2021, stated on the Commission's official website

OFFICIAL PAGE READ → 2 September 2026; repository status re-verified 13 August 2026

INSTRUMENTS → Annual Capacity Building Plans and the Karmayogi Competency Model

CORE CLAIM

MECHANISM

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP → the Commission sets standards; it does not operate the platform.

STAGE 06 DATED CAPACITY ANCHORS

DATED CAPACITY ANCHORS CABINET APPROVAL 2 SEPTEMBER 2020, MINISTRY OF PERSONNEL, PUBLIC GRIEVANCES AND COMMISSION ESTABLISHED 1 APRIL 2021, STATED ON THE COMMISSION'S OFFICIAL WEBSITE OFFICIAL PAGE READ 2 SEPTEMBER 2026; REPOSITORY STATUS RE-VERIFIED 13 AUGUST 2026

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CORE CLAIM

- CABINET APPROVAL → 2 September 2020, Ministry of Personnel, Public Grievances and Pensions
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MECHANISM

- OFFICIAL PAGE READ → 2 September 2026; repository status re-verified 13 August 2026
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CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- CABINET APPROVAL → 2 September 2020, Ministry of Personnel, Public Grievances and Pensions
- COMMISSION ESTABLISHED → 1 April 2021, stated on the Commission's official website

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: INSTRUMENTS → Annual Capacity Building Plans and the Karmayogi Competency Model.

STAGE 07 OUTPUT AGAINST OUTCOME

OUTPUT AGAINST OUTCOME ENROLMENT, COURSE COUNTS, COMPLETIONS, CERTIFICATES ON A LIVE DASHBOARD COMPETENCY-TO-POST FIT AND TRAINED BEHAVIOUR VISIBLE IN WORK PRODUCTS SERVICE TIMELINES, GRIEVANCE RECURRENCE, APPEAL OUTCOMES, TENURE STABILITY

NO PLATFORM TOTAL IS ASSERTED ANYWHERE; THE NUMBER CHANGES

CORE CLAIM

OUTPUT → enrolment, course counts, completions, certificates on a live dashboard
OUTCOME → competency-to-post fit and trained behaviour visible in work products

MECHANISM

OUTCOME → service timelines, grievance recurrence, appeal outcomes, tenure stability
DISCIPLINE → no platform total is asserted anywhere; the number changes daily

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

OUTPUT → enrolment, course counts, completions, certificates on a live dashboard
OUTCOME → competency-to-post fit and trained behaviour visible in work products

CORE CLAIM

- OUTPUT → enrolment, course counts, completions, certificates on a live dashboard
- OUTCOME → competency-to-post fit and trained behaviour visible in work products

MECHANISM

- OUTCOME → service timelines, grievance recurrence, appeal outcomes, tenure stability
- DISCIPLINE → no platform total is asserted anywhere; the number changes daily

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- OUTPUT → enrolment, course counts, completions, certificates on a live dashboard
- OUTCOME → competency-to-post fit and trained behaviour visible in work products

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: DISCIPLINE → no platform total is asserted anywhere; the number changes daily.

STAGE 08 GENERALIST, SPECIALIST AND LATERAL ENTRY

GENERALIST, SPECIALIST AND LATERAL ENTRY BREADTH FOR COORDINATION ACROSS SECTORS AND LEVELS OF GOVERNMENT DEPTH FOR TECHNOLOGY, FINANCE AND CLIMATE POLICY COMPLEXITY LATERAL ENTRY BOUNDED, PERIODIC RECRUITMENT AT JOINT SECRETARY, DIRECTOR, DEPUTY SECRETARY

SHORTER CONTRACTUAL TENURE AND WEAKER SOCIALISATION INTO PERMANENT-SERVICE NORMS

CORE CLAIM

GENERALIST → breadth for coordination across sectors and levels of government
SPECIALIST → depth for technology, finance and climate policy complexity

MECHANISM

LATERAL ENTRY → bounded, periodic recruitment at Joint Secretary, Director, Deputy Secretary
LIMIT → shorter contractual tenure and weaker socialisation into permanent-service norms

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

GENERALIST → breadth for coordination across sectors and levels of government
SPECIALIST → depth for technology, finance and climate policy complexity

CORE CLAIM

- GENERALIST → breadth for coordination across sectors and levels of government
- SPECIALIST → depth for technology, finance and climate policy complexity

MECHANISM

- LATERAL ENTRY → bounded, periodic recruitment at Joint Secretary, Director, Deputy Secretary
- LIMIT → shorter contractual tenure and weaker socialisation into permanent-service norms

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- GENERALIST → breadth for coordination across sectors and levels of government
- SPECIALIST → depth for technology, finance and climate policy complexity

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT → shorter contractual tenure and weaker socialisation into permanent-service norms.

STAGE 09 HOW NEUTRALITY ERODES

HOW NEUTRALITY ERODES UNCONSTRAINED POSTING AND TRANSFER DISCRETION OFFICERS ANTICIPATE THE POLITICAL EXECUTIVE'S PREFERENCE BEFORE ADVICE IS PERMANENCE PROTECTS THE OFFICE, NOT THE POST DISPLACEMENT IS EASIER THAN DISMISSAL ANONYMITY TURNS ASYMMETRIC

PUBLIC BLAME IN CONTROVERSY, INVISIBILITY IN ACHIEVEMENT PERCEIVED PARTIALITY ERODES THE LEGITIMACY OF UNELECTED DISCRETIONARY POWER

UNCONSTRAINED POSTING AND TRANSFER DISCRETION

officers anticipate the political executive's preference before advice is asked for

permanence protects the office, not the post: displacement is easier than dismissal

anonymity turns asymmetric: public blame in controversy, invisibility in achievement

perceived partiality erodes the legitimacy of unelected discretionary power

CORE CLAIM

- UNCONSTRAINED POSTING AND TRANSFER DISCRETION
- officers anticipate the political executive's preference before advice is asked for

MECHANISM

- permanence protects the office, not the post: displacement is easier than dismissal
- anonymity turns asymmetric: public blame in controversy, invisibility in achievement

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- perceived partiality erodes the legitimacy of unelected discretionary power
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Political neutrality is not constitutional value-neutrality, anonymity...

09

STAGE 09

HOW NEUTRALITY ERODES

HOW NEUTRALITY ERODES

UNCONSTRAINED POSTING AND TRANSFER DISCRETION

OFFICERS ANTICIPATE THE POLITICAL EXECUTIVE'S PREFERENCE BEFORE ADVICE IS

PERMANENCE PROTECTS THE OFFICE, NOT THE POST

DISPLACEMENT IS EASIER THAN DISMISSAL

ANONYMITY TURNS ASYMMETRIC

PUBLIC BLAME IN CONTROVERSY, INVISIBILITY IN ACHIEVEMENT

PERCEIVED PARTIALITY ERODES THE LEGITIMACY OF UNELECTED DISCRETIONARY POWER

UNCONSTRAINED POSTING AND TRANSFER DISCRETION

officers anticipate the political executive's preference before advice is asked for

permanence protects the office, not the post: displacement is easier than dismissal

anonymity turns asymmetric: public blame in controversy, invisibility in achievement

perceived partiality erodes the legitimacy of unelected discretionary power

CORE CLAIM

UNCONSTRAINED POSTING AND TRANSFER DISCRETION

officers anticipate the political executive's preference before advice is asked for

MECHANISM

permanence protects the office, not the post: displacement is easier than dismissal

anonymity turns asymmetric: public blame in controversy, invisibility in achievement

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

perceived partiality erodes the legitimacy of unelected discretionary power

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Political neutrality is not constitutional value-neutrality, anonymity...

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: Political neutrality is not constitutional value-neutrality, anonymity.

10

STAGE 10

REFORM CONFLICT LADDER

REFORM CONFLICT LADDER

FIXED MINIMUM TENURE

REPAIRS ARBITRARY TRANSFER; CAN ENTRENCH A POOR PERFORMER

PERFORMANCE ACCOUNTABILITY

REPAIRS NON-PERFORMANCE; CAN BECOME A POLITICAL LEVER

LATERAL ENTRY

REPAIRS DOMAIN DEFICIT; RAISES REPRESENTATION AND MEMORY QUESTIONS

CONTRACTUAL MISSION-MODE STAFFING

FIXED MINIMUM TENURE → repairs arbitrary transfer; can entrench a poor performer

PERFORMANCE ACCOUNTABILITY → repairs non-performance; can become a political lever

LATERAL ENTRY → repairs domain deficit; raises representation and memory questions

CONTRACTUAL MISSION-MODE STAFFING → buys speed; weakens tenure and neutrality guarantees

EVIDENCE LIMIT: AUTHORITY / IMPLEMENTATION: Use the National Programme for Civil Services

CORE CLAIM

FIXED MINIMUM TENURE → repairs arbitrary transfer; can entrench a poor performer

PERFORMANCE ACCOUNTABILITY → repairs non-performance; can become a political lever

MECHANISM

LATERAL ENTRY → repairs domain deficit; raises representation and memory questions

CONTRACTUAL MISSION-MODE STAFFING → buys speed; weakens tenure and neutrality guarantees

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

EVIDENCE LIMIT: AUTHORITY / IMPLEMENTATION: Use the National Programme for Civil Services...

FIXED MINIMUM TENURE → repairs arbitrary transfer; can entrench a poor performer

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EVIDENCE LIMIT: AUTHORITY / IMPLEMENTATION: Use the National Programme for Civil Services.

11

STAGE 11

ANSWER SPINE FOR A CIVIL-SERVICES DEMAND

ANSWER SPINE FOR A CIVIL-SERVICES DEMAND

NAME THE FUNCTION BEING TESTED RATHER THAN LISTING DUTIES

THE THREE-TRAIT PACKAGE, THEN THE LEGITIMACY LAYER THE STEM

PAIR EVERY REFORM WITH THE RISK IT BUYS AND

GRADED VERDICT, OUTCOME INDICATORS INSTEAD OF DASHBOARD TOTALS, STATED

OPEN → name the function being tested rather than listing duties of the service

BUILD → the three-trait package, then the legitimacy layer the stem actually engages

CORRECT → pair every reform with the risk it buys and the protection that reconciles

CLOSE → graded verdict, outcome indicators instead of dashboard totals, stated ownership

CORE CLAIM

OPEN → name the function being tested rather than listing duties of the service

BUILD → the three-trait package, then the legitimacy layer the stem actually engages

MECHANISM

CORRECT → pair every reform with the risk it buys and the protection that reconciles it

CLOSE → graded verdict, outcome indicators instead of dashboard totals, stated ownership

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

OPEN → name the function being tested rather than listing duties of the service

BUILD → the three-trait package, then the legitimacy layer the stem actually engages

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE → graded verdict, outcome indicators instead of dashboard totals, stated ownership.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

THE DOCTRINE OF DEMOCRATIC GOVERNANCE IMPLIES A RECIPROCAL OBLIGATION

CIVIL SERVANTS

MISSION KARMAYOGI'S COMPETENCY FRAMEWORK, BY MAKING SPECIFIC BEHAVIOURAL AND

LATERAL ENTRY INTERSECTS WITH THE NEUTRALITY/PERMANENCE DESIGN

A LATERAL ENTRANT

MISSION KARMAYOGI (NPCSCB), APPROVED BY CABINET ON 2 SEPTEMBER

THE ARCHITECTURE DISTINGUISHES APEX GUIDANCE (PM'S HR COUNCIL), COORDINATION

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

CAUTION: The Doctrine of Democratic Governance implies a reciprocal obligation: civil servants

CAUTION: Mission Karmayogi's competency framework, by making specific behavioural and domain

CAUTION: Lateral entry intersects with the neutrality/permanence design: a lateral entrant

Mission Karmayogi (NPCSCB), approved by Cabinet on 2 September 2020, is structured

ADVANCED DEBATE

The architecture distinguishes apex guidance (PM's HR Council), coordination (Cabinet

CAUTION: Lateral-entry recruitment rounds have periodically inducted domain specialists at

CAUTION: A well-publicised instance of an honest civil servant being transferred shortly after

CAUTION: Boundary case: a civil servant who is procedurally compliant and personally honest but

LEGACY / NUANCE

CAUTION: A lateral entrant bringing specific technical expertise (e.g., cybersecurity policy)

CAUTION: Emphasising perceptual legitimacy risks incentivising visible, symbolic

CAUTION: Expanding lateral entry to more positions could dilute permanence-based institutional

CAUTION: Mission Karmayogi's competency-based reform requires sustained multi-year

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.